PGConf.EU 2027: Venue Requirements Summary

About the event

PostgreSQL Conference Europe (PGConf.EU) is the annual European conference for users and developers of PostgreSQL, the open source database. It is organised by PostgreSQL Europe, a non-profit association registered in France, and has been held in a different European city every year since 2009 except for 2020 and 2021 during the covid pandemic. Recent editions include:

Year	**City**	**Venue**	**Attendees**
2026	Valencia	Palacio de Congresos	~750 (projected)
2025	Riga	Radisson Blu Latvija	675
2024	Athens	Divani Caravel	782
2023	Prague	Clarion Congress Hotel	722
2022	Berlin	Berlin Marriott	604

For 2027 we expect **700 to 800 attendees** in **late October** (whilst avoiding major holidays, both in the host country and other holidays recognized in large parts of Europe), over four event days, preferably Tuesday to Friday (Monday to Thursday is the alternative). We also need partial access the day before for set-up, and the morning after for tear-down.

Event shape

Day	**What happens**	**Numbers**
Day 0 (partial)	Organiser office from 08:00; common areas, registration and sponsor set-up from 12:00. Venue sets up talk rooms if necessary.	Organisers and sponsors only, no catering.
Days 1 to 3	Main conference: plenary, four parallel tracks, sponsor exhibition	700 to 900
Day 4	Community day: smaller workshops and sessions	200 to 300

Day	What happens	Numbers
Day 5 (partial)	Office only, morning, for collection of shipments	Organisers only, no catering

Examples of past schedules for the event s can be seen at https://www.postgresql.eu/events/pgconfeu2025/schedule/ and https://www.postgresql.eu/events/pgconfeu2026/schedule/

Spaces

Days 1 to 3

- A plenary for up to 900, theatre style (this may be partitioned into breakouts if the change can be done within a 30-minute break).
- Four to five breakout rooms: three for 300+ and one for 200+, theatre or classroom style.
- A “hacker lounge” for about 25 people, with tables, comfortable seating and power.
- A small quiet room for 6 to 8 people.
- Sponsor exhibition space for 12 to 15 stands in high-traffic areas near catering. Each stand holds a table of about 2 m wide, with space behind for sponsor staff and banners and in front for visitors (roughly 3 x 3 m each). Each stand must have access to electricity and the option to rent - for example - a large TV screen for their marketing material.
- A registration area with about 6 m of desk, ideally near the main entrance.

Day 4

- Five to six rooms of 50 to 100 people each, in classroom (ideally) or theatre layout, with power for the attendees to charge laptops etc..

Days 0 to 5

- A lockable organiser office of at least 25 m².

Audio visual and recording

- Every talk room needs projection or screens, microphones, sound and HDMI laptop input, with enough technicians on site to resolve problems promptly. We expect each speaker to bring and use their own laptop.
- Video recording of Days 1 to 3 talks is desirable, quoted as an option: one camera per room, audio from the sound desk, and a simple composed output (slides plus speaker).
- We may run our own live captioning system, which would need an audio output from each room's mixer and an on-stage monitor.

Power, Wi-Fi and logistics

- **Power:** power strips for work tables (mainly Day 4 and the lounges), registration, sponsor stands and the office. We need about 120 strips, installed by the venue.
- **Wi-Fi:** capacity for around 1,800 devices across all areas, ideally with a custom network name and no captive portal.
- **Deliveries:** the venue accepts shipments for us and our sponsors about a week ahead, and either brings them to us or makes them available for collection.

Catering

- Coffee, tea, water and cold drinks throughout the day
- A buffet or sit-down lunch, on Days 1 to 4 (700 to 900 covers on Days 1 to 3, up to 300 on Day 4). Lunch is scheduled for all attendees at the same time, and must be handled in a break of approximately one hour.
- Two catered coffee breaks (snacks/pastries/fruits etc) each day, one in the mid-morning and one in the mid-afternoon.
- Common dietary requirements catered for and labelled.
- Optionally, an evening reception on Day 1 or 2 for all attendees including drinks and small snacks (not a full meal)

Accessibility

Step-free access throughout, accessible toilets on every floor we use, and reserved accessible seating in talk rooms.

Accommodation

Bedrooms are paid for by individual attendees or groups thereof. The conference will only pay for a very small number of rooms on the master bill, but we want to provide the option to stay at or close to the venue in an easy way for all our attendees.

- **Hotel venues:** a conference rate for attendees, bookable directly online, covering at least Sunday to Sunday around the event.
- **Congress centres:** suggestions of nearby hotels are welcome.

How we work with venues

We have had very good experiences with many venues over the years, and a few that were less so, usually because of unexpected costs after contracts were signed. To avoid that for both sides, we ask that:

- **All foreseeable costs are in the quote.** This includes any staff, services, suppliers or fees the venue knows will be required for an event of this size (for example security, fire safety staff, technician time, set-up labour or mandatory items for exhibition stands).

- **Our detailed requirements form part of the agreement.** The full document and the venue's response to it are referenced in the final contract.
- **Sponsor extras are billed to sponsors directly.** Anything a sponsor adds (equipment hire, furniture, shipping and so on) is invoiced to the sponsor, not to PostgreSQL Europe (ordering will still go through PostgreSQL Europe, and we will forward the required invoicing details).

Next steps

This is a summary. We have a complete requirements specification covering each area in detail, with a simple response form to make quoting straightforward.

If the above looks like a good fit for your venue and dates, please let us know and we will send the full document for a detailed quote, and to discuss any details or clarify any requirements.